



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we use a boiling water canner when canning fruits at home?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because fruit is high acid and boiling water kills molds, yeasts, and bacteria.

FUN FACT

Fruit is acidic, so the boiling water temperature is enough to keep it safe.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

When watching an adult put fruit into jars to save for later, why do they leave a little empty space at the top of the jar instead of filling it all the way to the lid?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

So there's room for the fruit to expand and to help the jar close tightly without spilling.

FUN FACT

Leaving a little empty space at the top helps the jar seal shut properly, keeping the fruit fresh and stopping spills!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When making syrup for canning fruit, what is the syrup used for?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

It covers the fruit in jars and keeps it moist and tasty.

FUN FACT

Syrup can be light, medium, or heavy depending on how sweet you want the fruit.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What is the difference between a raw pack and a hot pack when canning fruit?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Raw pack means putting raw fruit into jars; hot pack means heating the fruit in syrup or water before packing.

FUN FACT

Hot pack can make fruit firmer and makes sure fruit is heated before sealing.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

How do you know if a jar lid has sealed properly after canning fruit?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

The lid is popped down in the center and does not move when pressed.

FUN FACT

A good seal means air was removed and the fruit is safe to store.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why should you not soak fruits in water before canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because soaking lowers fruit quality and may increase spoilage risk.

FUN FACT

Quick washing keeps fruits fresh and safe for canning.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

When a grown-up is canning certain fruits like Asian pears, why do they add bottled lemon juice first?



CANNING FRUITS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because adding lemon juice helps keep the fruit safe by making it more acidic.

FUN FACT

Adding a little lemon juice to some fruits helps stop bad germs from growing when food is canned.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is the correct way to prepare jars before filling them with fruit for canning?



CANNING FRUITS

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Wash with hot soapy water, rinse, then keep jars hot in a dishwasher or boiling water canner.

FUN FACT

Hot jars help prevent breaking when filled with hot fruit or syrup.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What should you do if the water in the canner stops boiling during the entire fruit processing time?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Bring it back to a full boil and start timing the process over again.

FUN FACT

Keeping water boiling kills germs and makes canned fruit safe to eat.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

How much headspace should you leave when canning most fruits in jars?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Usually 1/2 inch of headspace.

FUN FACT

The right headspace helps the jar seal and keeps fruit from spilling.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we heat the syrup, water, or juice before pouring it over the fruit in hot pack canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To help prevent jars from breaking and to get rid of air bubbles.

FUN FACT

Hot liquid helps fruit stay firm and tasty during canning.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

Q

What is the main reason to remove screw bands from jars after canning fruit?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To prevent the bands from rusting and ruining the seal.

FUN FACT

Removing bands helps your canned fruit last longer in storage.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What type of jars should you use for home canning fruits?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Standard Mason jars that are heat tempered and fit new lids.

FUN FACT

Using the right jars helps prevent breaking and sealing problems.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

If a jar didn't seal properly after canning fruit, what should you do?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Refrigerate and use soon or reprocess with a new lid within 24 hours.

FUN FACT

Reprocessing jars keeps food safe and avoids waste.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What happens if you leave jars in hot water after processing instead of taking them out to cool?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Spoilage may occur because fruit can overcook or jars might not seal properly.

FUN FACT

Cooling jars properly helps keep your canned fruit yummy.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is it important to select fresh, firm fruit for canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because overripe or damaged fruit can spoil faster and lower quality.

FUN FACT

The best fruit makes the best canned snacks!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

How does fruit acidity help in safe boiling water canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Acid stops harmful bacteria from growing inside the jar.

FUN FACT

Fruits like tomatoes may need lemon juice added to be safe for canning.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When watching a grown-up get fruit ready to freeze in jars, what do they need to do to keep the jars safe in the freezer?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Leave extra space at the top of the jar so the fruit can expand without breaking the glass.

FUN FACT

Leaving extra space in the jar helps stop the glass from cracking when the fruit freezes and expands.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

Q

When a grown-up is helping make canned fruit that cooks for less than 10 minutes, why do they boil the empty jars for 10 minutes before adding the fruit?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To make sure the jars are really clean and safe for the fruit.

FUN FACT

Cleaning jars carefully helps keep canned fruit fresh and tasty for a long time!

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

Q

When packing berries for canning, why is the quality of canned strawberries usually poor?

CANNING FRUITS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because strawberries lose texture and don't hold up well in canning.

FUN FACT

Other berries usually keep better for canning than strawberries.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables